Can You Defend Your Pass/Fail Decisions?

Independent blind analysis of a synthetic professional certification dataset.

Decision requested: Approve a focused evidence-collection and independent-review program before reconsidering operational scoring or passing policy.

Conclusion: Correct scoring implementation is established within the supplied records. Substantive validity and operational comparability of certification decisions remain unestablished.

What is supported

Scoring reconstruction across **2,400 administrations** found **0 raw-score mismatches and 0 pass/fail mismatches** against the supplied key and rule. This supports implementation consistency, not the substantive validity of the key or standard. [1]

Priority item inquiries differ: ANC_14 shows negative functioning across methods and both forms; ANC_18 shows higher conditional credit probability for North than South by **11.51 percentage points in A** and **11.11 in B**; B_11 has very weak discrimination and unstable model difficulty. These are grounds for expert review, not established key error, bias or invalidity. [2-3]

Observed first-attempt pass rates are **A 73.40%** and **B 61.94%**, from distinct, unadjusted candidate groups. Assignment and population evidence are needed before attributing the difference to form difficulty. [4]

Under the provisional common-item link and common assumed population, an A score of 42 corresponds to approximately **B=38.70**, with a **95% bootstrap interval of 38.15-39.13**. **This is not an authorized conversion or recommended new passing cut.** The interval remains conditional on model, reference-population and anchor assumptions. [5]

Hypothetical cross-form agreement under the unchanged **42/60 rule on both forms** is **86.59% overall** versus **46.30%** at the fixed modeled proficiency where A's expected score equals 42. The latter is not an observed-score group or a validated mastery threshold. These are model estimates under independent responses and unchanged proficiency, not observed retest results or actual error rates. [6]

Leadership sequence

1. **Verify standard authority and evidence first.** Obtain the approved competency blueprint, standard-setting rationale and governance approvals; preserve original content, keys and records.
2. **Start independent item and regional review.** Supply stems, options, rationales, job requirements and administration records; require documented findings before proposing remedies.
3. **Establish form comparability.** Obtain assembly/assignment, cohort and omission evidence before independent anchor and linking validation.
4. **Test real decision behavior.** Plan independent-cohort and parallel/repeat studies addressing practice, exposure and proficiency change. Future operational changes require separate authorization after prerequisites are met.

Decision boundary

Substantive accuracy remains unidentified without independently validated competence criteria. No historical errors, defective key, established unfairness, replacement cut or operational interchangeability are demonstrated. Same-dataset convergence is not external replication. The recommendation is evidence collection and explicit review gates, not a declaration of program failure.

Evidence notes [1-6] follow the main brief; exact sources and action dependencies are retained in the internal evidence map.